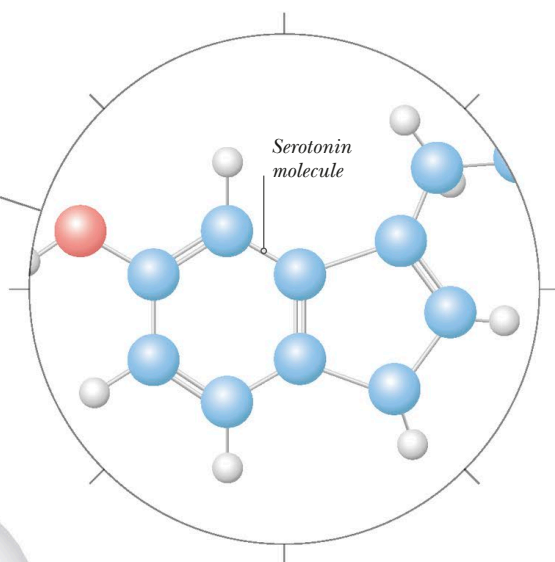




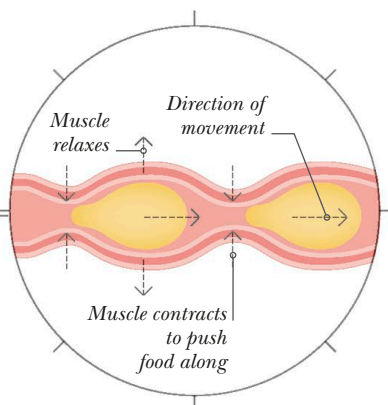
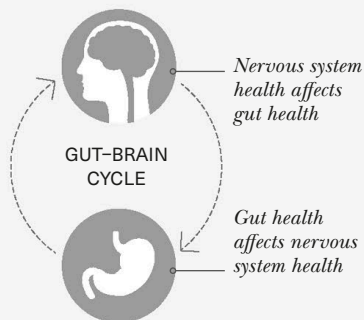
Gut brain

About 95 percent of your serotonin, a chemical needed for mood regulation, is stored in and partially controlled by your gut. "Gut brain" or enteric nervous system (see right) dysfunction is associated with gastrointestinal upset and irritable bowel syndrome (IBS), depression, and anxiety.



Enteric nervous system (ENS)

Scientists have recently discovered the semi-independent enteric nervous system (ENS). These 100 million neurons may be responsible for you feeling butterflies in your stomach from love or having an intuitive gut feeling. Yoga enhances your mind-body connection, so you can feel what is going on in your gut clearly. This interconnection may explain how yoga can improve both your digestion and mood significantly.



Peristalsis

Peristalsis is the involuntary smooth muscular movement of food through your digestive tract. It's encouraged by the relaxation response and physical movement, as from yoga asana practice.



Ahimsa diet

Yogis often make conscious choices about what they put into their body. An ahimsa diet is one of nonharm. For many, this means being a vegetarian to reduce the suffering of other animals. A largely plant-based diet reduces your risk of heart disease, cancer, and related major killers. Scientists project that a mostly vegetarian diet may reduce global mortality by 6–10 percent and cut food-based greenhouse gas emissions by 29–70 percent—a huge impact on the environment. Even small dietary changes like a Meatless Monday can make a big difference.



NONHARM FOOD